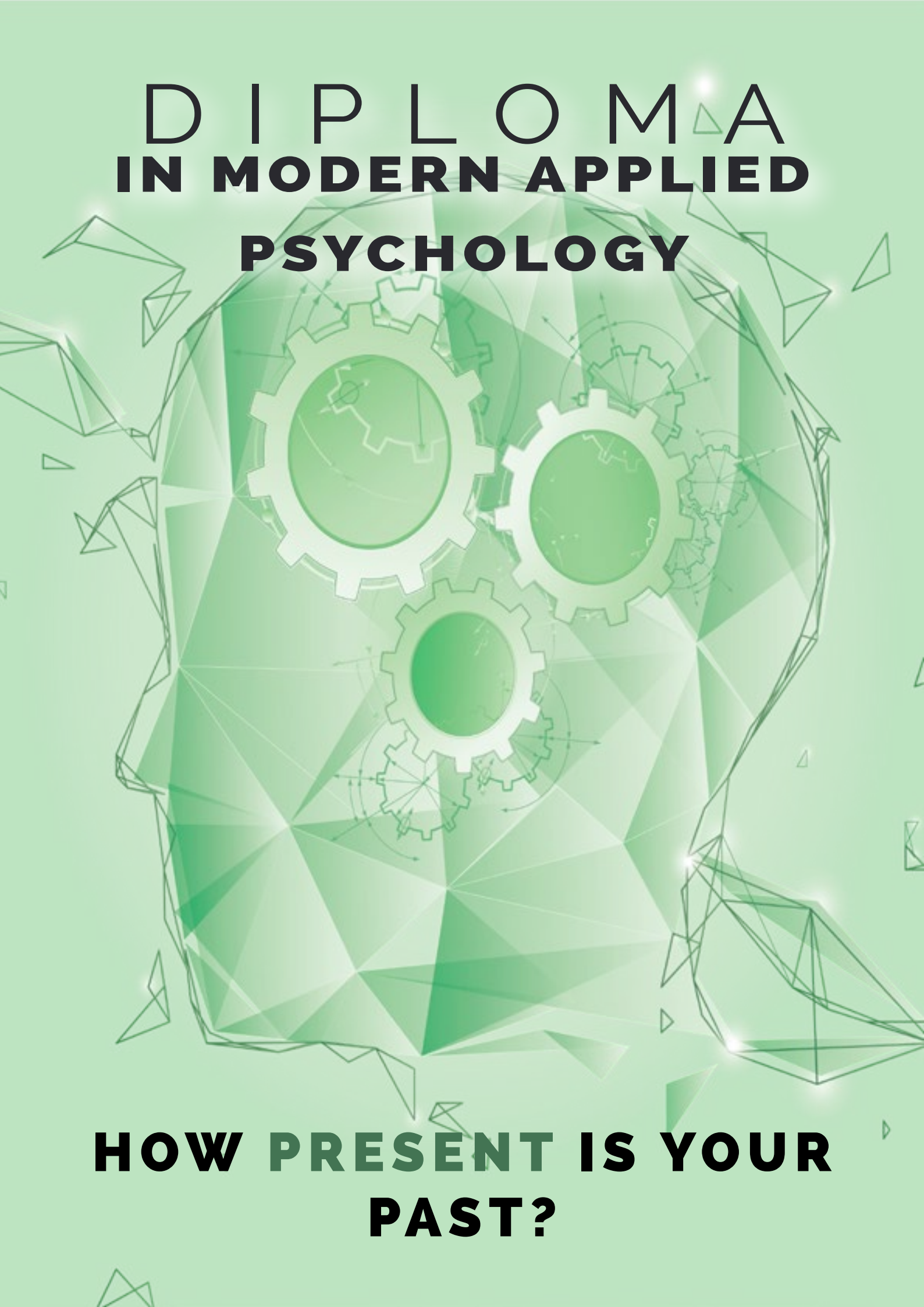


DIPLOMA IN MODERN APPLIED PSYCHOLOGY

The background is a vibrant green with a complex, low-poly geometric pattern. Overlaid on this are three interlocking gears of varying sizes, rendered in a lighter green with white outlines. A faint, white wireframe of a human head is visible, with the gears positioned within the brain area. The overall aesthetic is modern and technological.

**HOW PRESENT IS YOUR
PAST?**

HOW PRESENT IS YOUR PAST?

"If you are depressed you are living in the past. If you are anxious, you are residing in the future. If you are at peace, you are awake in the present." - Lao Tzu

Most of us know that having negative experiences in childhood can affect us in our day-to-day adult lives. Depending on the extremity of our childhood experiences, the beliefs we develop about ourselves as an adult will be influenced by what we learned about ourselves as a child.

Psychological psychodynamic theory suggests that many of our perceptions, opinions, beliefs and ideologies in life are formed through a variety of past experiences, some remembered (sub-consciously), and some forgotten (which become unconscious).

All of our past life experiences impact who we are today, how we conduct ourselves, how we relate to ourselves, how we relate to others and how well we relate to our pasts. History has a habit of either making people or breaking people.

In this way, it's crucial that we develop an awareness of the past, without becoming transfixed on it, so that we become more mindfully aware of the perceptions that have arisen from our past experiences, and in turn, how these perceptions might be informing and impacting our present.

This requires that we become aware of how our past is affecting us today so that we are no longer ruled by our unconscious, but rather; we are free from our unconscious and in turn able to make well-informed choices about how we respond to the situations, circumstances and events of our day-to-day lives.

If we have not made peace with the past, it can end up governing our present ways of being, acting, thinking, behaving and interacting with others. With this in mind, how present is your past?

"The secret of health for both mind and body is not to mourn for the past, nor to worry about the future, but to live the present moment wisely and earnestly." - Bukkyo Dendo Kyokai

This exercise, which is in three parts, invites you to consider this concept in relation to self, the evolution of your personal history and the nature of your relationships today.

Part 1

Take 10-15 minutes to reflect and make brief notes of what your answers are to the following questions:

Q1. What is your earliest memory of childhood? (Try to recall a particular incident or event, not just an image or fragmentary impression).



HOW **PRESENT** IS YOUR PAST?

Q2. What are your impressions of yourself, and of the other people in the memory?

Q3. How might this memory have contributed to the evolution of your personal history and the quality of your past relationships?

Q4. How might your experience back then, have contributed to your patterns of forming and managing relationships today?

Part 2

Take 10-15 minutes to write a story or reflection about how your earliest childhood memory has impacted how you interact with other people and manage your relationships today.

If you are happy to, share your story in the Q&A section of this lecture so that other students can benefit from your honesty and experience.

YOUR STORY/REFLECTION

